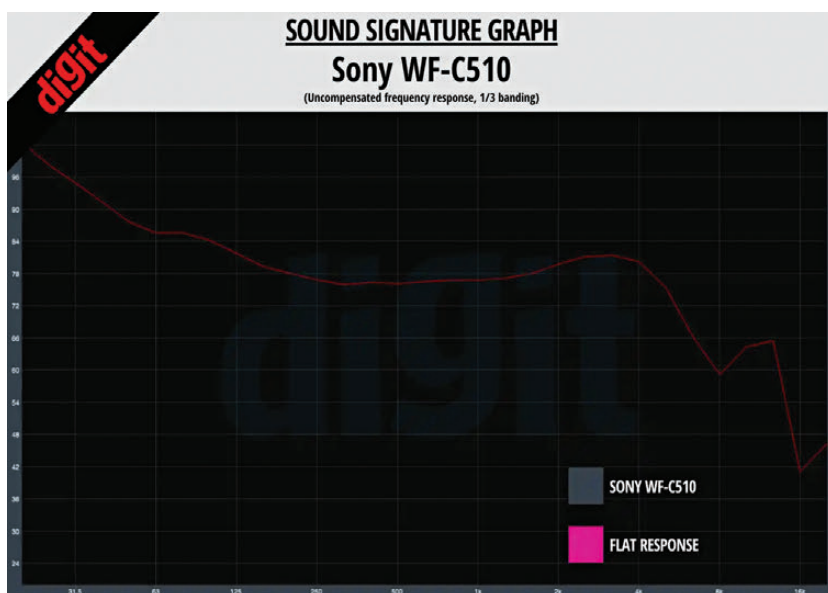


clearly tuned these in-ear earphones to let vocals and instrumentation shine through. The midrange is well-defined, with a level of clarity that is particularly noticeable on vocal-heavy tracks. Singers' voices, whether in pop, rock, or even acoustic genres, feel forward and lifelike, giving the listener a more intimate experience with the music. This also benefits instruments such as guitars, strings, and pianos, which come across with satisfying texture and detail. It's not a studio-level reproduction, but for casual listening, the WF-C510 handles mids with surprising competence.

Treble/Highs: The high frequencies on the WF-C510 are smooth and slightly rolled off, providing a warm, comfortable listening experience without harshness or sibilance. However, this tuning approach does mean that some fine details in the upper frequencies may be less pronounced. For instance, the "sparkle" often found in cymbals, hi-hats, and certain string instruments is more subdued here, which might not satisfy audiophiles looking for an extremely detailed treble. On the positive side, the relaxed highs make the WF-C510 a solid option for extended listening, as there's very little risk of ear fatigue.

Soundstage and Imaging: While the WF-C510 doesn't create the expansive soundstage found in over-ear headphones, it does a decent job for in-ear buds. There's a sense of space that allows instruments and vocals to be somewhat distinct, though the overall imaging is more compressed, as expected at this price point. The stereo separation is decent enough for most listeners to enjoy spatial nuances, but for those seeking a truly immersive experience with layered depth, higher-end options will be more fulfilling.

Noise isolation: The passive isolation on these in-ear earphones, thanks to the great fit that I got with these in-ear earphones, ensured that a lot of ambient sound during my time of use was eliminated. However, I am talking about my experience in a rather silent



office space. If you are looking to step in noisier environments, you will miss ANC on these in-ear earphones.

Microphone: The microphone on the Sony WF-C510 offers a functional performance for casual calls but may not be ideal for demanding scenarios like professional video calls or noisy environments. Sony has equipped the WF-C510 with a basic microphone setup that captures voice clearly in quiet settings, so for quick calls or voice notes, it does a fine job. The microphone maintains a natural tone, avoiding the overly processed or tinny sound that can sometimes affect budget earbuds. However, in busier environments, the microphone does struggle to isolate the user's voice from background noise. If call quality is a top priority, especially in noisy environments, users might need to consider options with dedicated noise reduction technology.

BATTERY LIFE

The battery life on the Sony WF-C510 is exceptional as was the case with the WF C-500. In my test, with the volume set to 50 per cent, the earbuds lasted exactly 10 hours and 15 minutes, which is more than most other earphones that have hit the Test Labs since I have started working on audio reviews. The claimed battery life on these earphones

is 11 hours, so the expectation vs reality is not much of a letdown. The charging time, however, as per the brand, is 1.5 hours to go from 0 to 100, which means you will have to wait for some time. But, what you get in return makes up for this.

VERDICT

The bottom line with the Sony WF-C510 is, buy these in-ear earphones only for the audio experience. At this price, such sound is hard to come by. And, when coupled with the battery life, the Sony WF-C510 makes for a great purchase. However, if you are looking for a more feature-rich offering, especially with ANC, you will need to look elsewhere. Your options would include the realme Buds Air6 Pro, which is priced in a similar price range as these earphones, and if you are looking for an even more pocket-friendly offering, then the CMF Buds Pro 2 are your best bet.

—Sativk Pandey

SPECIFICATIONS

Drivers: 6 mm drivers | Frequency Response: 20 Hz to 20 kHz | Weight: 31g | Colours: Black, White, Yellow, Blue | Bluetooth: v5.4 | Battery: 8 hours | Bluetooth Range: 10m, v5.3

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